

trick called “faux columns” a little later, which is a technique that makes use of a simple tiled background image to fool us into thinking that columns are of the same equal height.

The two column layout is more than enough to create a typical blog layout or simple web site. There are, however, many more layout options available to you, including alternative methods of creating a liquid two-column layout, which we’ll look at next.

Here each column has been given a bottom margin of 10 pixels to create a space between them and the footer. So, instead of having to add this declaration to every column, can it not just be added to the footer using a top margin. Unfortunately this cannot be done. When you clear a float, the top margin of the clearing element (the footer in this case) is automatically increased so that the top border clears the bottom outer edge of the floated elements. Therefore, with no top margin on the footer and no bottom margins on the columns, the minimum clearance is done automatically, and in this case, 10 pixels is the same more or less as the automatically added top margin, so there is no difference. So you must use a bottom margin on the floated columns in order to create a visible margin between them and the cleared footer.

9.4 Liquid float left, float right

The previous method of floating just the sidebar was good. Still, from a semantic point of view, the main sections were in the wrong order in the markup (sidebar before content). The beauty of the `float:left/float:right` approach is that we can return to more semantically structured markup.

If you are still working through the examples, first switch the order of the content and sidebar IDs in `columns.css`, so that the order is as follows:

```
<div id="masthead">
...masthead content goes here...
</div>
<div id="content">
...main content goes here...
</div>
<div id="sidebar">
...sidebar content goes here...
</div>
<div id="footer">
```